

Gratitude Cards

*The nightly share, printable prompt cards, the jar and the letter, a 7-day log, and the solo version ·
Module 4, Training 4*

The science in one breath

Gratitude journaling improved mood, optimism and sleep (Emmons & McCullough, *JPSP*); expressed gratitude in couples predicted both partners feeling more connected the next day (Algoe, Gable & Maisel, *Personal Relationships*); gratitude letters increased happiness and reduced depressive symptoms (Toepfer et al., *Journal of Happiness Studies*); expressed gratitude linked to oxytocin-pathway variation (Algoe & Way, *SCAN*); gratitude writing associated with brain changes months later (Kini et al., *NeuroImage*).

The nightly share (3 minutes, phones away)

Each of you, at the pillow: 1. **One specific thing I'm grateful for today.** 2. **One specific thing I appreciated about you today.**

Rules: specific beats general · no "but", no hidden requests · the only reply to thanks is "thank you for noticing" · it happens on the bad days too (small counts: "the hot water was hot").

Example: "Grateful for: the walk this morning; the light was beautiful and my head was clear.

Appreciated about you: you didn't try to fix it when I was upset about the test. You just sat with me."

The gratitude jar

A jar, slips of paper, a pen on the counter. Drop one in whenever you notice something. Empty it together on the first of the month, or on a hard night.

The gratitude letter (once a month)

One handwritten page to your partner about something specific they did this month and what it meant. Read it aloud. Forty awkward seconds, then not.

If gratitude has gone quiet

One text a day: "Thank you for the coffee this morning." No expectation of a reply. After a week, move it to the pillow.

Printable prompt cards (cut along the rules; keep on the nightstand)

Something you did for me today that I didn't thank you for.

A moment today when I felt close to you.

Something small you do that I've stopped noticing.

A way you've supported me on this journey that I want you to know I saw.

Something I'm grateful for about our home.

Something about my own body I'm grateful for today.

A way I showed up for myself today.

Something I'm looking forward to with you.

The kindest thing anyone did for me today.

Something hard today that I'm grateful we faced together.

Solo version

Each night: one specific thing I'm grateful for, and one specific thing I appreciate about how I showed up today. Once a week: a gratitude to my body for what it *did*, not how it looked. ("Thank you for carrying me through that walk.")

7-day log (40 XP: practice · 30 XP: log)

NIGHT	SHARED?	GRATEFUL FOR (MINE)	APPRECIATED (THEIRS / ABOUT ME)	MOOD AFTER 1-10
1	☐			
2	☐			
3	☐			
4	☐			
5	☐			
6	☐			
7	☐			

Hardest night to do it, and what I said anyway:

Tie-in: start your weekly Partner Agreement check-in (Module 1) with a round of gratitude before anything else.

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Educational content only, not medical advice. Always consult your doctor or a qualified health professional before changing supplements, diet, exercise or detox practices, especially while trying to conceive.